

Contractions

	be	will	would	have	had
I	I am I'm	I will I'll	I would I'd	I have I've	I had I'd
you	you are you're	you will you'll	you would you'd	you have you've	you had you'd
he	he is he's	he will he'll	he would he'd	he has he's	he had he'd
she	she is she's	she will she'll	she would she'd	she has she's	she had she'd
it	it is it's	it will it'll	it would it'd	it has it's	it had it'd
we	we are we're	we will we'll	we would we'd	we have we've	we had we'd
they	they are they're	they will they'll	they would they'd	they have they've	they had they'd
that	that is that's	that will that'll	that would that'd	that has that's	that had that'd
who	who is who's	who will who'll	who would who'd	who has who's	who had who'd

Verbs and <i>not</i>	Contraction
is not	isn't
are not	aren't
was not	wasn't
were not	weren't
have not	haven't
has not	hasn't
had not	hadn't
will not	won't
would not	wouldn't
do not	don't
does not	doesn't
did not	didn't
cannot	can't
could not	couldn't
should not	shouldn't
might not	mightn't
must not	mustn't

Auxiliary verbs and <i>have</i>	would have	should have	could have	might have	must have
Contraction	would've	should've	could've	might've	must've

Common punctuation errors

Comma splice

A comma between two clauses creates a “comma splice” if it is used without a conjunction. The comma needs to be replaced with either a semicolon or a period, or the text can be rewritten to use a comma and a conjunction.

- ✗ You cook, I'll do the dishes.
- ✓ You cook, **and** I'll do the dishes.

Greengrocer's apostrophe

An unnecessary apostrophe incorrectly placed before the plural s is called a “greengrocer's apostrophe.”

- ✗ carrot's
- ✓ carrots
- ✗ apple's
- ✓ apples

Hyphen in a compound modifier

Using a hyphen in a compound modifier that includes an adverb ending in -ly is incorrect. These compound modifiers are never hyphenated.

- ✗ cleverly-planned meeting
- ✓ cleverly planned meeting

Misuse of *your* and *you're*

Confusion between *your* and *you're* can be avoided by remembering that *you're* is a contraction made up of two separate words: *you* and *are*.

- ✗ It's in **you're** bag.
- ✓ It's in **your** bag.
- ✗ **Your** mistaken.
- ✓ **You're** mistaken.